# DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY

**CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1761 → DECLINE AS A CONVERGING → SUCCESSION AND THE SAYYID → FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS → THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP → THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

## 00 STAGE 00 — CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1761

CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1761 · 1707-12 BAHADUR SHAH · 1712-13 JAHANDAR/ZULFIQAR · 1713-19 FARRUKHSIYAR/SAYYIDS · 1719 BRIEF EMPERORS · 1719-48 MUHAMMAD SHAH · 1720 SAYYID FALL · 1739 NADIR SHAH

1707-12 Bahadur Shah → 1712-13 Jahandar/Zulfiqar → 1713-19 Farrukhsiyar/Sayyids → 1719 brief emperors → 1719-48 Muhammad Shah → 1720 Sayyid fall → 1739 Nadir Shah

**CHRONOLOGY / PHASE**
- 1707-12 Bahadur Shah → 1712-13 Jahandar/Zulfiqar
- 1713-19 Farrukhsiyar/Sayyids → 1719 brief emperors
- 1719-48 Muhammad Shah
- 1720 Sayyid fall

**MATERIAL / INSTITUTION**
- 1739 Nadir Shah
- 1748-54 Ahmad Shah → 1754-59 Alamgir II → Shah Jahan III/Shah Alam II
- 1748-67 Abdali invasions
- 1761 Third Panipat

**IMPACT / LIMIT**
- BOUND → Buxar 1764/Diwani 1765 and Company state belong Modern History.
- MUST REMEMBER: Mughal decline was multi-causal: jagirdari stress, succession, war, regional power and fiscal-military change interacted.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Mughal decline was multi-causal: jagirdari stress, succession, war, regional power and fiscal-military change interacted.**

## 01 STAGE 01 — DECLINE AS A CONVERGING SYSTEM

DECLINE AS A CONVERGING SYSTEM · ONE WEAK RULER + ONE RELIGION + ONE BATTLE · SUCCESSION + NOBLE FACTION + JAGIR/AGRARIAN STRESS + WAR · SUCCESSOR STATES AND RESISTANCE POWERS REORGANISE AUTHORITY · NADIR/ABDALI EXPLOIT AND DEEPEN PRE-EXISTING WEAKNESS · DYNASTY, TRADE, AGRICULTURE AND CULTURE PERSIST UNEVENLY · CENTRAL CONTRACTION PLUS REGIONAL REORDERING.

NOT → one weak ruler + one religion + one battle + immediate collapse

STRUCTURE → succession + noble faction + jagir/agrarian stress + war → REGION → successor states and resistance powers reorganise authority → SHOCK → Nadir/Abdali exploit and deepen pre-existing weakness

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- NOT → one weak ruler + one religion + one battle + immediate collapse
- STRUCTURE → succession + noble faction + jagir/agrarian stress + war

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- REGION → successor states and resistance powers reorganise authority
- SHOCK → Nadir/Abdali exploit and deepen pre-existing weakness

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- CONTINUITY → dynasty, trade, agriculture and culture persist unevenly
- VERDICT → central contraction plus regional reordering.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTINUITY → dynasty, trade, agriculture and culture persist unevenly.**

## 02 STAGE 02 — SUCCESSION AND THE SAYYID WIZARAT

SUCCESSION AND THE SAYYID WIZARAT · NO PRIMOGENITURE · PRINCE NEEDS PROVINCE + ARMY + NOBLE/RAJPUT COALITION · SEAL/TITLE/APPOINTMENT LEGITIMACY PERSISTS AFTER COERCIVE DECLINE · COMPETE FOR ACCESS, JAGIRS, GOVERNORSHIPS AND SUCCESSION · ABDULLAH + HUSAIN ALI MAKE/UNMAKE EMPERORS; FARRUKHSIYAR 1719 · 1720 FALL · DOES NOT RESTORE UNCONTESTED MONARCHY

NO PRIMOGENITURE → prince needs province + army + noble/Rajput coalition → EMPEROR → seal/title/appointment legitimacy persists after coercive decline → WAZIR/NOBLES → compete for access, jagirs, governorships and succession → SAYYIDS → Abdullah + Husain Ali make/unmake emperors; Farrukhsiyar 1719 → 1720 FALL → does not restore uncontested monarchy

**CHRONOLOGY / PHASE**
- NO PRIMOGENITURE → prince needs province + army + noble/Rajput coalition
- EMPEROR → seal/title/appointment legitimacy persists after coercive decline

**MATERIAL / INSTITUTION**
- WAZIR/NOBLES → compete for access, jagirs, governorships and succession
- SAYYIDS → Abdullah + Husain Ali make/unmake emperors; Farrukhsiyar 1719

**IMPACT / LIMIT**
- 1720 FALL → does not restore uncontested monarchy
- TRAP → Irani/Turani/Hindustani labels are networks, not permanent parties.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → Irani/Turani/Hindustani labels are networks, not permanent parties.**

## 03 STAGE 03 — FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS

FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS · TRANSFERABLE REVENUE ASSIGNMENT · RANK/SERVICE CLAIM · REVENUE POOL AWAITING/AVAILABLE FOR ASSIGNMENT · DELAY OR SHORTAGE OF SUITABLE PRODUCTIVE ASSIGNMENT · PAPER ASSESSMENT · REALISED COLLECTION · RESTRAINS ENTRENCHMENT BUT ENCOURAGES SHORT-TERM EXTRACTION

| JAGIR → transferable revenue assignment | MANSAB → rank/service claim |
|---|---|
| JAMA → paper assessment | HASIL → realised collection |

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- JAGIR → transferable revenue assignment
- MANSAB → rank/service claim
- PAIBAQI → revenue pool awaiting/available for assignment

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- BE-JAGIRI → delay or shortage of suitable productive assignment
- JAMA → paper assessment
- HASIL → realised collection

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- TRANSFER → restrains entrenchment but encourages short-term extraction
- RULE → crisis means malfunction and scarcity, not disappearance of jagirs.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → crisis means malfunction and scarcity, not disappearance of jagirs.**

## 04 STAGE 04 — THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP

THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP · MORE CLAIMS · MANSABDARS + DECCANI/MARATHA ENTRANTS + COURT REWARDS · POOR JAGIR · LOW HASIL + DEBT + THIN CONTINGENT · SHORT TENURE ENCOURAGES COERCION/CORRUPTION · LOCAL RESPONSE · ZAMINDAR BARGAIN/RESISTANCE + PEASANT FLIGHT + CHAUTH

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- MORE CLAIMS → mansabdars + Deccani/Maratha entrants + court rewards
- POOR JAGIR → low hasil + debt + thin contingent

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- EXTRACT → short tenure encourages coercion/corruption
- LOCAL RESPONSE → zamindar bargain/resistance + peasant flight + chauth

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- RESULT → still lower hasil → faction for better office/assignment
- VERDICT → fiscal + administrative + military + social feedback.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → fiscal + administrative + military + social feedback.**

## 05 STAGE 05 — THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN

THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN · ANNEXATION + FORTS + GARRISONS + LONG SUPPLY + · DEFEATED DECCANI/MARATHA ELITES ENTER MUGHAL SERVICE SYSTEM · MARATHA WAR · PARALLEL REVENUE AND MOBILE RESISTANCE REDUCE COLLECTION · AURANGZEB CHOICE · BUFFERS REMOVED AND SETTLEMENTS MISSED · EARLIER MANSAB GROWTH + AGRARIAN/LOCAL POWER + NO PRIMOGENITURE

1687-1707 → annexation + forts + garrisons + long supply + emperor absent north → CLAIMANTS → defeated Deccani/Maratha elites enter Mughal service system → MARATHA WAR → parallel revenue and mobile resistance reduce collection → AURANGZEB CHOICE → buffers removed and settlements missed → INHERIT → earlier mansab growth + agrarian/local power + no primogeniture

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- 1687-1707 → annexation + forts + garrisons + long supply + emperor absent north
- CLAIMANTS → defeated Deccani/Maratha elites enter Mughal service system

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- MARATHA WAR → parallel revenue and mobile resistance reduce collection
- AURANGZEB CHOICE → buffers removed and settlements missed

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- INHERIT → earlier mansab growth + agrarian/local power + no primogeniture
- TRAP → responsibility matters, but one ruler did not create every structure.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → responsibility matters, but one ruler did not create every structure.**

## 06 STAGE 06 — FROM CENTRE TO REGION: A SPECTRUM

FROM CENTRE TO REGION · A SPECTRUM · EMPEROR RETAINS LEGITIMACY AND TITLES · AUTONOMOUS PROVINCE · MUGHAL GOVERNOR CONTROLS REVENUE/ARMY, NOMINAL LOYALTY · SUCCESSOR STATE · DURABLE COURT AND PROVINCIAL FISCAL-MILITARY REGIME · RESISTANCE STATE

CENTRE → emperor retains legitimacy and titles

AUTONOMOUS PROVINCE → Mughal governor controls revenue/army, nominal loyalty → SUCCESSOR STATE → durable court and provincial fiscal-military regime → RESISTANCE STATE → zamindar/community/military base builds new authority

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- CENTRE → emperor retains legitimacy and titles
- AUTONOMOUS PROVINCE → Mughal governor controls revenue/army, nominal loyalty

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- SUCCESSOR STATE → durable court and provincial fiscal-military regime
- RESISTANCE STATE → zamindar/community/military base builds new authority

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- TRIBUTE/CHAUTH → influence without uniform direct administration
- RULE → devolution and adaptation, not simple secession or anarchy.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → devolution and adaptation, not simple secession or anarchy.**

## 07 STAGE 07 — BENGAL, AWADH AND HYDERABAD COMPARED

BENGAL, AWADH AND HYDERABAD COMPARED · MURSHID QULI KHAN: REVENUE CONTROL + COMMERCE + NOMINAL · SAADAT KHAN; ZAMINDAR MANAGEMENT + GANGA MILITARY-FISCAL BASE · NIZAM-UL-MULK; DECCAN BASE AFTER WITHDRAWAL FROM DELHI FACTION · MUGHAL TITLES/OFFICES/ADMINISTRATION AND PERSIANATE COURT · ECOLOGY, REVENUE, MILITARY NETWORK AND COMPANY EXPOSURE · AUTONOMY DID NOT BEGIN WITH MODERN INDEPENDENCE DECLARATIONS.

| POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY | EVIDENCE / MECHANISM | DEBATE / LEGACY |
|---|---|---|
| BENGAL → Murshid Quli Khan; revenue control + commerce + nominal tribute | HYDERABAD → Nizam-ul-Mulk; Deccan base after withdrawal from Delhi faction | DIFFER → ecology, revenue, military network and company exposure |
| AWADH → Saadat Khan; zamindar management + Ganga military-fiscal base | COMMON → Mughal titles/offices/administration and Persianate court | TRAP → autonomy did not begin with modern independence declarations. |

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- BENGAL → Murshid Quli Khan; revenue control + commerce + nominal tribute
- AWADH → Saadat Khan; zamindar management + Ganga military-fiscal base

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- HYDERABAD → Nizam-ul-Mulk; Deccan base after withdrawal from Delhi faction
- COMMON → Mughal titles/offices/administration and Persianate court

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- DIFFER → ecology, revenue, military network and company exposure
- TRAP → autonomy did not begin with modern independence declarations.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → autonomy did not begin with modern independence declarations.**

## 08 STAGE 08 — JATS, SIKHS AND MARATHAS: BOUNDED SNAPSHOT

JATS, SIKHS AND MARATHAS · BOUNDED SNAPSHOT · CHURAMAN/BADAN SINGH/SURAJ MAL; BHARATPUR FORTS + ZAMINDARI/ROUTES · BANDA PHASE · MISLS/DAL KHALSA · AFGHAN SERVICE/MIGRATION NETWORKS ESTABLISH ROHILKHAND POWER · SHAHU + PESHWA + HOLKAR/SCINDIA/GAEKWAD/BHONSLE · CHAUTH/SARDESHMUKHI + MOBILE ARMIES + BARGAINING

JATS → Churaman/Badan Singh/Suraj Mal; Bharatpur forts + zamindari/routes

SIKHS → Banda phase → repression/reorganisation → misls/Dal Khalsa → ROHILLAS → Afghan service/migration networks establish Rohilkhand power → MARATHAS → Shahu + Peshwa + Holkar/Scindia/Gaekwad/Bhonsle

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- JATS → Churaman/Badan Singh/Suraj Mal; Bharatpur forts + zamindari/routes
- SIKHS → Banda phase → repression/reorganisation → misls/Dal Khalsa

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- ROHILLAS → Afghan service/migration networks establish Rohilkhand power
- MARATHAS → Shahu + Peshwa + Holkar/Scindia/Gaekwad/Bhonsle

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- INSTRUMENT → chauth/sardeshmukhi + mobile armies + bargaining
- TRAP → no single anti-Mughal bloc or uniform successor empire.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → no single anti-Mughal bloc or uniform successor empire.**

## 09 STAGE 09 — NADIR SHAH, ABDALI AND PANIPAT

NADIR SHAH, ABDALI AND PANIPAT · 1739 KARNAL · MUGHAL COMMAND/FACTION FAILURE · DELHI SACK AND EXTRACTION · DEVASTATING RAID AND EXPOSURE; NOT ORIGINAL CAUSE OR INDIAN · ABDALI 1748-67 · REPEATED PUNJAB/NORTH-INDIA INTERVENTIONS · ABDALI COALITION DEFEATS MARATHAS; MUGHAL EMPEROR NOT MAIN BELLIGERENT

1739 KARNAL → Mughal command/faction failure → Delhi sack and extraction → NADIR → devastating raid and exposure; not original cause or Indian annexation → ABDALI 1748-67 → repeated Punjab/north-India interventions → 1761 → Abdali coalition defeats Marathas; Mughal emperor not main belligerent → CAUSE → supply + alliances + non-combatants + Rohilla/Abdali coordination

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- 1739 KARNAL → Mughal command/faction failure → Delhi sack and extraction
- NADIR → devastating raid and exposure; not original cause or Indian annexation
- ABDALI 1748-67 → repeated Punjab/north-India interventions

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- 1761 → Abdali coalition defeats Marathas; Mughal emperor not main belligerent
- CAUSE → supply + alliances + non-combatants + Rohilla/Abdali coordination
- LIMIT → Panipat checks northern bid, not Maratha power or British inevitability.

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Hyderabad, Awadh and Bengal were successor states that adapted Mughal institutions, not mere evidence of anarchy.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Hyderabad, Awadh and Bengal were successor states that adapted Mughal institutions, not mere evidence of anarchy.**

## 10 STAGE 10 — REGIONAL ECONOMIC AND CULTURAL CONTINUITY

REGIONAL ECONOMIC AND CULTURAL CONTINUITY · AGRICULTURE + TEXTILES + INTERNAL TRADE + CREDIT + · WAR + MULTIPLE LEVIES + ROUTE INSECURITY + INVASION · COMMERCIAL STRENGTH CAN COEXIST WITH WEAK DELHI CENTRE · AWADH/HYDERABAD/RAJASTHAN/PUNJAB/BENGAL/MARATHA COURTS · MOVEMENT CREATES REGIONAL STYLES USING MUGHAL FORMS · POLITICAL FRAGMENTATION IS NOT CIVILISATIONAL DARKNESS. · EVIDENCE LIMIT

CONTINUE → agriculture + textiles + internal trade + credit + urban demand

DISRUPT → war + multiple levies + route insecurity + invasion by region → BENGAL → commercial strength can coexist with weak Delhi centre → PATRONAGE → Awadh/Hyderabad/Rajasthan/Punjab/Bengal/Maratha courts

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- CONTINUE → agriculture + textiles + internal trade + credit + urban demand
- DISRUPT → war + multiple levies + route insecurity + invasion by region
- BENGAL → commercial strength can coexist with weak Delhi centre

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- PATRONAGE → Awadh/Hyderabad/Rajasthan/Punjab/Bengal/Maratha courts
- ARTISTS/LITERATI → movement creates regional styles using Mughal forms
- VERDICT → political fragmentation is not civilisational darkness.

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: The eighteenth century is a transition with regional growth and new competition, not a teleological prelude to British rule.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EVIDENCE LIMIT: The eighteenth century is a transition with regional growth and new competition, not a teleological prelude to British rule.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The eighteenth century is a transition with regional growth and new competition, not a teleological prelude to British rule.**

## 11 STAGE 11 — NON-INEVITABILITY AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE

NON-INEVITABILITY AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE · 1687-1707 BURDEN · 1707-39 COURT/REGION · 1739-61 MULTIPOLARITY · JAGIR FEEDBACK + SUCCESSION/WIZARAT + LOCAL/REGIONAL POWER · NADIR/ABDALI REVEAL AND DEEPEN WEAKNESS · ECONOMY/CULTURE AND MUGHAL LEGITIMACY CONTINUE UNEVENLY · SARKAR + CHANDRA + AGRARIAN + REGIONAL SYNTHESIS

PERIODISE → 1687-1707 burden → 1707-39 court/region → 1739-61 multipolarity → EXPLAIN → jagir feedback + succession/wizarat + local/regional power → SHOCK → Nadir/Abdali reveal and deepen weakness → QUALIFY → economy/culture and Mughal legitimacy continue unevenly → HISTORIOGRAPHY → Sarkar + Chandra + agrarian + regional synthesis

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- PERIODISE → 1687-1707 burden → 1707-39 court/region → 1739-61 multipolarity
- EXPLAIN → jagir feedback + succession/wizarat + local/regional power
- SHOCK → Nadir/Abdali reveal and deepen weakness

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- QUALIFY → economy/culture and Mughal legitimacy continue unevenly
- HISTORIOGRAPHY → Sarkar + Chandra + agrarian + regional synthesis
- PYQ → zero direct Topic-25 routes, 2018-2026; Mains has no key

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- BRIDGE → fragmentation permits Company gains; Modern History explains them.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HISTORIOGRAPHY → Sarkar + Chandra + agrarian + regional synthesis.**

## E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ADVANCED EVIDENCE NOTEBOOK · TWENTY-FOUR SOURCE-TO-ARGUMENT LABS · EVIDENCE AND ANSWER-WRITING DRILLS · DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY · 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA · 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION · 3. STUDY LINKS

**OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH**
- Advanced evidence notebook: twenty-four source-to-argument labs
- Evidence and answer-writing drills
- Decline of the Mughal Empire & the Eighteenth Century — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline

**ADVANCED DEBATE**
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

**LEGACY / NUANCE**
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles
- + Historiography ladder (PYQ-gap)

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels